ritual cult. His works include the *Nareshvaraparikshaprakasha* and commentaries on the *Matangaparameshavara Agama* and the *Kiranatantra* as well as commentaries on works by *Sadyojyoti*.

His principal opponents include Buddhists in the tradition of ***Dignaga*** and ***Dharmakirti***, some of whose theories had been translated into a metaphysic of absolute idealism by ***Utpaladeva*** who belonged to the rival Kashmiri Shaiva ***Pratyabhijna*** school.

He defends the view that individual souls are permanent centres of knowledge and agency. Individual thinking subjects are basic realities in the sense that, while tables and chairs need observers to establish their identities, souls need no external establishment. He refutes the Buddhist view that we are just streams of experiences superimposing continuity upon themselves, maintaining that the persisting identity and responsible agency of the soul is self-evident to each individual and pointing out the disastrous implications for human behaviour were it accepted that the one who performs the deed is other than the one who experiences its results. This involves a refutation of the Buddhist repudiation of real structures of causes and effects in favour of the mere occurrence of successive events. He also criticises forms of Buddhist idealism in defending the *Siddhantin* belief that we experience a real objective environment that has been created by God. He thinks that the existence of God can be proved by inference: the world consists of composite realities; whatever is composite has a conscious maker adequate to its complexity.

Further reading: Goodall 1998; Sanderson 1992

Ramanuja (fl. 1100 CE): *Ramanuja* was a theologian of theistic ***Vedanta*** resolutely opposed to the non-dualist (*advaita*) traditions. He wanted to show that the beliefs